

Complete HTML Tags Reference

A Beginner's Complete Guide to All HTML Tags

1. Heading Tags

Tag	Syntax	Description / Usage
<h1>	Text	Biggest heading on the page. Used for the main title. Only use once per page.
<h2>	Text	Second biggest heading. Used for main sections of a page.
<h3>	Text	Third level heading. Used for sub-sections under h2.
<h4>	Text	Fourth level heading. Smaller than h3, used for deeper sub-sections.
<h5>	Text	Fifth level heading. Rarely used, very small heading.
<h6>	Text	Smallest heading. Used for minor labels or footnote-level headings.

2. Text Formatting Tags

Tag	Syntax	Description / Usage
<p>	Text	Paragraph tag. Used to write a block of text. Each <p> starts on a new line.
	Text	Bold tag. Makes text bold. Use for visual styling only.
	Text	Strong tag. Makes text bold AND tells browser this is important content.
<i>	<i>Text</i>	Italic tag. Makes text slanted/italic. Use for visual styling.
	Text	Emphasis tag. Makes text italic AND tells browser this text is emphasized.
<u>	<u>Text</u>	Underline tag. Adds underline to text.
<s>	<s>Text</s>	Strikethrough tag. Draws a line through text. Used for deleted or old content.
<mark>	<mark>Text</mark>	Highlight tag. Highlights text in yellow, like a marker pen.
<small>	Text	Small tag. Makes text smaller than normal size.
<big>	<big>Text</big>	Big tag. Makes text bigger than normal size.
<sub>	_{Text}	Subscript tag. Text appears below the normal line. Example: H2O

<sup>	^{Text}	Superscript tag. Text appears above the normal line. Example: x squared
<code>	<code>Text</code>	Code tag. Displays text in a monospace font, used for showing code.
<pre>	<pre>Text</pre>	Preformatted tag. Preserves spaces and line breaks exactly as typed.
<blockquote>	<blockquote>Text</blockquote>	Blockquote tag. Used for long quotations. Indents the text.
<q>	<q>Text</q>	Quote tag. Used for short inline quotations. Adds quotation marks automatically.
<abbr>	<abbr title='...'>Text</abbr>	Abbreviation tag. Defines an abbreviation. Shows full form on hover.
<cite>	<cite>Text</cite>	Citation tag. Used to reference a title of a work (book, movie, etc.).
	Text	Deleted tag. Shows text that has been deleted with a strikethrough.
<ins>	<ins>Text</ins>	Insert tag. Shows text that has been inserted, usually underlined.
	Text	Inline container. Used to style a small part of text without changing layout.
 	 	Line break. Forces text to move to the next line. Self-closing tag.
<hr>	<hr>	Horizontal rule. Draws a horizontal dividing line across the page.

3. Link Tags

Tag	Syntax	Description / Usage
<a>	Text	Anchor tag. Creates a clickable link. href attribute sets the destination URL.
<a> (email)	Email	Opens the user's email app with a pre-filled recipient address.
<a> (phone)	Call	On mobile, tapping this link dials the phone number directly.
<a> (target)	Text	Opens the link in a new browser tab using target='_blank'.

4. Image & Media Tags

Tag	Syntax	Description / Usage
		Image tag. Displays an image. src sets file path, alt gives description for screen readers.

<audio>	<audio src='...' controls></audio>	Audio tag. Embeds an audio player on the page. 'controls' shows play/pause buttons.
<video>	<video src='...' controls></video>	Video tag. Embeds a video player on the page. 'controls' shows play/pause.
<source>	<source src='...' type='...>	Source tag. Used inside audio/video to specify multiple file formats.
<iframe>	<iframe src='url'></iframe>	Inline frame. Embeds another web page inside your page. Used to embed YouTube, Google Maps etc.
<figure>	<figure>...</figure>	Figure tag. Used to wrap an image with its caption together as a group.
<figcaption>	<figcaption>Text</figcaption>	Caption tag. Goes inside <figure> to add a caption below an image.
<canvas>	<canvas id='c'></canvas>	Canvas tag. Creates a blank drawing area. Used with JavaScript to draw graphics.
<svg>	<svg>...</svg>	SVG tag. Used to create scalable vector graphics directly in HTML.

5. List Tags

Tag	Syntax	Description / Usage
	Item	Unordered list. Creates a bullet-point list.
	Item	Ordered list. Creates a numbered list (1, 2, 3...).
	Item	List item. Each item inside ul or ol must be wrapped in .
<dl>	<dl>...</dl>	Description list. Used for glossaries or key-value pairs.
<dt>	<dt>Term</dt>	Description term. The word or term being defined inside a <dl>.
<dd>	<dd>Def</dd>	Description detail. The definition or description of the <dt> term.

6. Table Tags

Tag	Syntax	Description / Usage
<table>	<table>...</table>	Table tag. The container for the entire table. All other table tags go inside this.
<tr>	<tr>...</tr>	Table row. Creates a horizontal row inside the table.
<td>	<td>Data</td>	Table data. Creates a regular cell inside a row. Contains your actual data.

<code><th></code>	<code><th>Header</th></code>	Table header. Like <code><td></code> but for heading cells. Text is bold and centered by default.
<code><thead></code>	<code><thead>...</thead></code>	Table head. Groups the header rows of a table together.
<code><tbody></code>	<code><tbody>...</tbody></code>	Table body. Groups the main content rows of a table.
<code><tfoot></code>	<code><tfoot>...</tfoot></code>	Table footer. Groups the footer rows, like totals at the bottom.
<code><caption></code>	<code><caption>Text</caption></code>	Table caption. Adds a title or description above the table.
<code>colspan</code>	<code><td colspan='2'></code>	Not a tag, but an attribute. Makes a cell span across 2 or more columns.
<code>rowspan</code>	<code><td rowspan='2'></code>	Not a tag, but an attribute. Makes a cell span across 2 or more rows.

7. Form Tags

Tag	Syntax	Description / Usage
<code><form></code>	<code><form action='...' method='...'></code>	Form container. Wraps all form elements. action sets where data is sent, method sets how (GET/POST).
<code><input></code>	<code><input type='text' name='...'></code>	Input field. Most versatile form tag. type attribute changes what kind of input it is.
<code><input text></code>	<code><input type='text'></code>	Single-line text input. Used for names, usernames etc.
<code><input password></code>	<code><input type='password'></code>	Password input. Text is hidden (shown as dots).
<code><input email></code>	<code><input type='email'></code>	Email input. Validates that the user enters a proper email format.
<code><input number></code>	<code><input type='number'></code>	Number input. Only allows numbers. Shows up/down arrows.
<code><input checkbox></code>	<code><input type='checkbox'></code>	Checkbox. Lets users select multiple options. Returns true/false.
<code><input radio></code>	<code><input type='radio'></code>	Radio button. Lets users select only ONE option from a group.
<code><input submit></code>	<code><input type='submit'></code>	Submit button. Sends the form data when clicked.
<code><input file></code>	<code><input type='file'></code>	File upload. Opens a file picker so users can upload files.
<code><input date></code>	<code><input type='date'></code>	Date picker. Shows a calendar to let users pick a date.
<code><input range></code>	<code><input type='range'></code>	Slider input. Lets users pick a value by dragging a slider.

<code><input color></code>	<code><input type='color'></code>	Color picker. Opens a color palette for users to choose a color.
<code><label></code>	<code><label for='id'>Text</label></code>	Label tag. Describes what an input is for. Clicking the label focuses the input.
<code><textarea></code>	<code><textarea rows='4'>...</textarea></code>	Multi-line text input. Used for comments, messages, long text.
<code><button></code>	<code><button type='submit'>Click</button></code>	Button tag. A clickable button. More flexible than input type submit.
<code><select></code>	<code><select name='...'>...</select></code>	Dropdown list container. Users can pick one option from a dropdown menu.
<code><option></code>	<code><option value='val'>Text</option></code>	Dropdown option. Goes inside <code><select></code> . Each option is one choice in the dropdown.
<code><optgroup></code>	<code><optgroup label='Group'></code>	Option group. Groups related options together inside a <code><select></code> dropdown.
<code><fieldset></code>	<code><fieldset>...</fieldset></code>	Fieldset tag. Groups related form elements together with a visible border.
<code><legend></code>	<code><legend>Title</legend></code>	Legend tag. Adds a title/caption to a <code><fieldset></code> group.

8. Page Layout & Semantic Tags

Tag	Syntax	Description / Usage
<code><div></code>	<code><div>...</div></code>	Division tag. A block-level container used to group and layout content. The most used layout tag.
<code></code>	<code>...</code>	Inline container. Groups inline content (text, images) without breaking the line flow.
<code><header></code>	<code><header>...</header></code>	Header tag. Contains the top section of a page — logo, navigation, banner.
<code><nav></code>	<code><nav>...</nav></code>	Navigation tag. Contains navigation links like a menu bar.
<code><main></code>	<code><main>...</main></code>	Main tag. Contains the main content of the page. Should be unique per page.
<code><section></code>	<code><section>...</section></code>	Section tag. Groups related content into a thematic section with a heading.
<code><article></code>	<code><article>...</article></code>	Article tag. Used for self-contained content like a blog post or news article.
<code><aside></code>	<code><aside>...</aside></code>	Aside tag. Contains side content like a sidebar, ads, or related links.
<code><footer></code>	<code><footer>...</footer></code>	Footer tag. Contains the bottom section — copyright, contact, links.
<code><details></code>	<code><details>...</details></code>	Details tag. Creates an expandable/collapsible section. Click to show/hide content.

<code><summary></code>	<code><summary>Text</summary></code>	Summary tag. The visible title of a <code><details></code> element. Acts as the toggle button.
<code><dialog></code>	<code><dialog open>...</dialog></code>	Dialog tag. Creates a popup dialog/modal box on the page.
<code><template></code>	<code><template>...</template></code>	Template tag. Holds HTML that is not rendered until used by JavaScript.

9. Document Structure Tags

Tag	Syntax	Description / Usage
<code><!DOCTYPE></code>	<code><!DOCTYPE html></code>	Document type declaration. Always the FIRST line. Tells browser this is HTML5.
<code><html></code>	<code><html lang='en'>...</html></code>	Root tag. All HTML content goes inside this tag. lang sets the page language.
<code><head></code>	<code><head>...</head></code>	Head tag. Contains metadata — not visible on page. Holds title, links, scripts.
<code><title></code>	<code><title>Page Name</title></code>	Title tag. Sets the name shown on the browser tab.
<code><body></code>	<code><body>...</body></code>	Body tag. All visible content goes here — text, images, buttons, etc.
<code><meta></code>	<code><meta charset='UTF-8'></code>	Meta tag. Provides metadata like character set, description, viewport settings.
<code><meta viewport></code>	<code><meta name='viewport' content='...'></code>	Makes the page responsive on mobile devices. Essential for mobile-friendly sites.
<code><link></code>	<code><link rel='stylesheet' href='...'></code>	Link tag. Connects external files to HTML, most commonly CSS stylesheets.
<code><style></code>	<code><style>css here</style></code>	Style tag. Lets you write CSS directly inside your HTML file.
<code><script></code>	<code><script src='...'></script></code>	Script tag. Links a JavaScript file or lets you write JS directly inside HTML.
<code><noscript></code>	<code><noscript>Text</noscript></code>	Noscript tag. Content shown only if the browser has JavaScript disabled.
<code><base></code>	<code><base href='...'></code>	Base tag. Sets a base URL for all relative links in the document.

Tip: Practice each tag by writing it yourself in VS Code. Learning by doing is the fastest way!

Total: 90+ HTML Tags Covered | Made for Beginners